



Windows 10 LTSC support

Microsoft announces that it will only support Windows 10 LTSC for five years.
<http://dgit.in/mar21-39>



Big sur for AWS

Amazon announces support for Mac devices via AWS.
<http://dgit.in/mar31-40>

and are meant just to be used with headphones on the go. All of the ones we've listed so far are capable of playing 96 kHz / 24-bit audio which is considered to be the starting point for Hi-Res audio. And in portable DACs, this is sort of the tip of the iceberg since circuits that are capable of playing better audio consume a lot more power. Which means, they aren't as portable since you will have to plug an external battery pack or power bank to get it to work. And if it

does rely on its internal battery then you won't get much battery life.

So there are a lot of considerations to keep in mind when picking a portable DAC. In our hunt for a DAC that had it all we ended up with the Fiio Q5S. It's slightly bulkier than the AudioQuest Dragonfly but you get a balanced output, a dedicated headphone jack, USB input and optical. There's also Bluetooth support, although one can see the folly in using a DAC with a Bluetooth

headphone, it's the fact that you have this one device that works with everything. What's better? It's got a 3700 mAh internal battery, so it can keep going for a long time. One look at the price tag and my friend started questioning his need for a full-fledged device. At 30K, the Fiio Q5S isn't exactly cheap. He finally settled for a Fiio A1 which was super cheap and a far cry from the Q5S in terms of audio quality. But at least, it solved his problem. **4**

BUYING ADVICE

HEADPHONES FOR WORK

Q Dear Agent001, I am planning to assemble a Gaming PC with a budget of ₹1,35,000 to 1,55,000. I want to be able to do 4K Gaming, with 16 GB RAM. Since I won't be upgrading the PC for probably 7 years, I want a processor and GPU that can support the Games lined up till around 2025 at high graphics (4K), especially GTA 6. Could you suggest a rig that fits in my budget with these specs?

My top 3 priorities are processor, GPU and Monitor. I also want to have at least 3 TB internal storage.

—Aditya Singh Rana

A Hey Aditya, The global chip shortage has caused graphics card prices to skyrocket. We're already talking about high-end graphics cards since you wish to game on 4K. This is the territory of the AMD RX 6800 XT and NVIDIA RTX 3080. Neither cards are easy to come by at the moment, and even if you do, they'll be ridiculously expensive. So much that you won't have any money left for anything else.

For the processor, you can either go with the AMD Ryzen 9 5900X or the Intel Core i9-10900K. The latter is cheaper at the moment. The 10900K can be paired with the ASUS PRIME

Z490P and 16 GB of DDR4 RAM clocked at 3200 or 3600 MHz. You will need a good CPU cooler, probably a Noctua NH-D15, NH-U14S or NH-U12A. You can also opt for a 240/280mm radiator AIO from any of the popular brands. Then for the boot drive, you can opt for the Samsung 970 EVO Plus 1 TB and probably a 2 TB hard drive or even a 2 TB Crucial P1 NVMe SSD if you want more speed.

with an IPS panel and has support for FreeSync. If you want a higher refresh rate, then I'd say you should scale down to 2K resolution for more options since 4K has very few high refresh rate panels.

All of this together will cost about 210K and you can play 4K games for the next five years. Since this is obviously higher than your stated budget, you'll have to scale down from the



NVIDIA RTX 3070

This entire setup will need a 750W power supply such as the Cooler Master MWE GOLD 750 V2. Pick whichever chassis you want, just check if it can house a 160mm tall cooler and a 30cm long graphics card. You would want something that supports 5-6 cooling fans. The Fractal Design Meshify C is a good choice.

Lastly, for the monitor, you're looking at a 4K panel since that's what you wish to game at. The LG 27UK650-W is a pretty good monitor

10900K to the Core i7 - 10700, RTX 3070 from the RTX 3080, a B460 Motherboard instead of the Z490 board. This should save enough money to bring it down to 160K and you'll still be able to game at 4K but with a few of the settings turned down. Founders Edition cards are available at their proper prices from RPTech but you'll have to wait a month. Ideally, start your build once you have secured the graphics card since that has the most volatile pricing currently. **4**